



# Aviation Investigation Final Report

|                                |                                      |                         |             |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-------------------------|-------------|
| <b>Location:</b>               | Kenai, Alaska                        | <b>Accident Number:</b> | ANC23LA011  |
| <b>Date &amp; Time:</b>        | January 2, 2023, 14:57 Local         | <b>Registration:</b>    | N94X        |
| <b>Aircraft:</b>               | Piper PA-18-150                      | <b>Aircraft Damage:</b> | Substantial |
| <b>Defining Event:</b>         | Loss of control on ground            | <b>Injuries:</b>        | 1 Minor     |
| <b>Flight Conducted Under:</b> | Part 91: General aviation - Personal |                         |             |

## Analysis

The pilot reported that, during landing on a road in flat light conditions he drifted to the right after touching down and the right tire struck unplowed snow. The pilot was unable to correct, and the airplane continued to the right into a snow berm. Subsequently, it nosed over sustaining substantial damage to the wings, lift struts, and rudder. The pilot reported no preimpact mechanical malfunctions or failures with the airplane that would have precluded normal operation.

## Probable Cause and Findings

The National Transportation Safety Board determines the probable cause(s) of this accident to be:

The pilot's failure to maintain directional control during landing in flat light conditions, resulting in the airplane to nose over.

## Findings

|                             |                                           |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| <b>Aircraft</b>             | Directional control - Capability exceeded |
| <b>Personnel issues</b>     | Aircraft control - Pilot                  |
| <b>Environmental issues</b> | Flat light - Contributed to outcome       |



## Factual Information

### History of Flight

|                      |                                            |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Landing-landing roll | Loss of control on ground (Defining event) |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------|

### Pilot Information

|                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                   |                 |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|-----------------|
| Certificate:              | Private                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Age:                              | 61,Male         |
| Airplane Rating(s):       | Single-engine land; Single-engine sea                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Seat Occupied:                    | Front           |
| Other Aircraft Rating(s): | None                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Restraint Used:                   | 3-point         |
| Instrument Rating(s):     | None                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Second Pilot Present:             | No              |
| Instructor Rating(s):     | None                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Toxicology Performed:             |                 |
| Medical Certification:    | Class 3 With waivers/limitations                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Last FAA Medical Exam:            | July 14, 2022   |
| Occupational Pilot:       | No                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Last Flight Review or Equivalent: | January 9, 2019 |
| Flight Time:              | 778 hours (Total, all aircraft), 320 hours (Total, this make and model), 750 hours (Pilot In Command, all aircraft), 3 hours (Last 90 days, all aircraft), 2 hours (Last 30 days, all aircraft), 1 hours (Last 24 hours, all aircraft) |                                   |                 |

### Aircraft and Owner/Operator Information

|                               |                                                        |                                |                 |
|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-----------------|
| Aircraft Make:                | Piper                                                  | Registration:                  | N94X            |
| Model/Series:                 | PA-18-150                                              | Aircraft Category:             | Airplane        |
| Year of Manufacture:          | 1962                                                   | Amateur Built:                 |                 |
| Airworthiness Certificate:    | Normal                                                 | Serial Number:                 | 18-7858         |
| Landing Gear Type:            | Tailwheel                                              | Seats:                         | 2               |
| Date/Type of Last Inspection: | October 25, 2022 Annual                                | Certified Max Gross Wt.:       | 1750 lbs        |
| Time Since Last Inspection:   | 1 Hrs                                                  | Engines:                       | 1 Reciprocating |
| Airframe Total Time:          | as of last inspection                                  | Engine Manufacturer:           | Lycoming        |
| ELT:                          | Installed, activated, did not aid in locating accident | Engine Model/Series:           | O-320           |
| Registered Owner:             | On file                                                | Rated Power:                   | 150 Horsepower  |
| Operator:                     | On file                                                | Operating Certificate(s) Held: | None            |

## Meteorological Information and Flight Plan

|                                  |                                  |                                         |             |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|-------------|
| Conditions at Accident Site:     | Visual (VMC)                     | Condition of Light:                     | Day         |
| Observation Facility, Elevation: |                                  | Distance from Accident Site:            |             |
| Observation Time:                | 14:57 Local                      | Direction from Accident Site:           |             |
| Lowest Cloud Condition:          | Unknown                          | Visibility                              | 10 miles    |
| Lowest Ceiling:                  | Overcast                         | Visibility (RVR):                       |             |
| Wind Speed/Gusts:                | / None                           | Turbulence Type<br>Forecast/Actual:     | None / None |
| Wind Direction:                  |                                  | Turbulence Severity<br>Forecast/Actual: | N/A / N/A   |
| Altimeter Setting:               | 2896 inches Hg                   | Temperature/Dew Point:                  | 0°C         |
| Precipitation and Obscuration:   | No Obscuration; No Precipitation |                                         |             |
| Departure Point:                 | Kenai, AK (ENA)                  | Type of Flight Plan Filed:              | None        |
| Destination:                     | Nikiski, AK (AK73)               | Type of Clearance:                      | Unknown     |
| Departure Time:                  | 14:45 Local                      | Type of Airspace:                       | Class G     |

## Airport Information

|                      |                         |                           |                           |
|----------------------|-------------------------|---------------------------|---------------------------|
| Airport:             | McGahan Industrial AK73 | Runway Surface Type:      |                           |
| Airport Elevation:   | 150 ft msl              | Runway Surface Condition: | Snow;Soft                 |
| Runway Used:         |                         | IFR Approach:             | None                      |
| Runway Length/Width: |                         | VFR Approach/Landing:     | Full stop;Traffic pattern |

## Wreckage and Impact Information

|                     |         |                      |                           |
|---------------------|---------|----------------------|---------------------------|
| Crew Injuries:      | 1 Minor | Aircraft Damage:     | Substantial               |
| Passenger Injuries: |         | Aircraft Fire:       | None                      |
| Ground Injuries:    |         | Aircraft Explosion:  | None                      |
| Total Injuries:     | 1 Minor | Latitude, Longitude: | 60.726361,-151.29916(est) |

## Administrative Information

**Investigator In Charge (IIC):** Ward, Mark

**Additional Participating Persons:** Scott Norman; FAA

**Original Publish Date:** March 30, 2023

**Last Revision Date:**

**Investigation Class:** [Class 4](#)

**Note:** The NTSB did not travel to the scene of this accident.

**Investigation Docket:** <https://data.nts.gov/Docket?ProjectID=106557>

The National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB) is an independent federal agency charged by Congress with investigating every civil aviation accident in the United States and significant events in other modes of transportation—railroad, transit, highway, marine, pipeline, and commercial space. We determine the probable causes of the accidents and events we investigate, and issue safety recommendations aimed at preventing future occurrences. In addition, we conduct transportation safety research studies and offer information and other assistance to family members and survivors for each accident or event we investigate. We also serve as the appellate authority for enforcement actions involving aviation and mariner certificates issued by the Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) and US Coast Guard, and we adjudicate appeals of civil penalty actions taken by the FAA.

The NTSB does not assign fault or blame for an accident or incident; rather, as specified by NTSB regulation, “accident/incident investigations are fact-finding proceedings with no formal issues and no adverse parties ... and are not conducted for the purpose of determining the rights or liabilities of any person” (Title 49 *Code of Federal Regulations* section 831.4). Assignment of fault or legal liability is not relevant to the NTSB’s statutory mission to improve transportation safety by investigating accidents and incidents and issuing safety recommendations. In addition, statutory language prohibits the admission into evidence or use of any part of an NTSB report related to an accident in a civil action for damages resulting from a matter mentioned in the report (Title 49 *United States Code* section 1154(b)). A factual report that may be admissible under 49 *United States Code* section 1154(b) is available [here](#).